

Explanation For The Astronomical Annual Calendar

The astronomical annual calendar provides a quick overview of the position of the planets throughout the year. A calendar with the corresponding months is shown on the right-hand side.

Within the months, lines are drawn on the 11th and 21st of the month for easy subdivision.

Time is shown at the top and bottom. They are used to easily recognize the planetary positions relative to the sun based on their culmination times.

To determine the position of a planet for a particular day, look for the date on the right and see its culmination (the highest position during the day) on the *horizontal* to the planet.

Strictly speaking, this is the time distance from the sun during the course of the day. The greater the distance, the better the visibility.

The top edge of the sheet also indicates the best time to observe the planet (evening, night or morning sky)

You can see at a glance when a particular planet can be observed during the year (in the evening, in the morning, all night or not at all).

Conjunctions and oppositions are also visible.

The sun line also shows that the sun does not reach its highest position at the same time every day (equation of time).

You can learn more about this, e. g. at the Papenburg Astronomical Observatory.